

Important Papers Checklist for Aging Parents

Know where the most important documents are before you urgently need them. This blank copy is for personal/family use. Parent Stay Home does not receive, save, store, or see this information.

Parent basic information

Parent full name		Preferred name	
Primary phone		Best person to contact first	
Street address			
City		State / ZIP	

Important document tracker

Use this table to note whether a document exists, where it is kept, and who knows how to access it. For the Exists column, use Yes, No, or Not sure. Avoid writing full account numbers, passwords, or sensitive details unless this document will be stored securely.

General information note: This checklist helps you organize information. It is not legal, financial, medical, or care-management advice. For decisions about legal documents, benefits, taxes, accounts, or medical directives, speak with the appropriate qualified professional.

#	Document / information	Exists? Yes / No / Not sure	Where kept	Who can access / notes
1	Will or estate plan	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
2	Power of attorney	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
3	Advance directive / healthcare proxy	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
4	Health insurance / Medicare cards	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
5	Prescription plan information	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
6	Medication list	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
7	Bank or credit union information	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
8	Pension, Social Security, or VA benefits	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
9	Tax records	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
10	Property deed, lease, or mortgage information	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
11	Vehicle title / registration / insurance	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
12	Funeral, burial, or final arrangement information	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		

Legal and decision-making documents

These documents may affect who can help with decisions or access information. Laws and requirements vary, so confirm with an attorney, healthcare provider, or other qualified professional when needed.

☐ Will	☐ Trust documents
☐ Financial power of attorney	☐ Healthcare power of attorney / proxy
☐ Advance directive / living will	☐ Guardianship or conservatorship papers, if applicable
☐ Do Not Resuscitate / MOLST / POLST form, if applicable	☐ Attorney contact information

Insurance, benefits, and medical information

Use this section to locate cards, letters, portals, and contacts. Do not cancel, change, or apply for benefits based only on a checklist; verify current rules with the relevant agency or qualified advisor.

☐ Medicare card	☐ Medicaid information, if applicable
☐ Supplemental insurance	☐ Prescription drug plan
☐ Long-term care insurance	☐ Veterans benefits information
☐ Social Security information	☐ Doctor and medication lists

Financial and household records

This section is meant to help families locate information, not take over decisions. Share financial information only with authorized, trusted people. Consider secure storage for sensitive access details.

☐ Bank / credit union names	☐ Credit card or loan information
☐ Pension / retirement account contacts	☐ Regular bills and due dates
☐ Utility account information	☐ Tax preparer contact
☐ Home insurance	☐ Safe deposit box location, if any

Digital access and security

Do not write passwords here unless this document will be stored securely for personal use. A safer approach may be to note where passwords are stored and who is authorized to access them.

Password manager or password book location		Phone/computer unlock help or notes	
Email account access notes		Important online account notes	
Digital access instructions			

Funeral, cemetery, and memorial contacts

This section is for organizing contact information and known wishes. It is not legal, financial, or funeral-planning advice. Confirm details directly with the funeral home, cemetery, attorney, or other qualified professional when needed.

Funeral home name		Funeral home phone / email	
Funeral home address			
Cemetery / burial location		Cemetery contact / phone	
Memorial, clergy, celebrant, or service contact		Prepaid or preplanned arrangements?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure
Where final arrangement documents or wishes are kept			
Notes, preferences, or people to contact			

Additional document rows

#	Document / information	Exists? Yes / No / Not sure	Where kept	Who can access / notes
13		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
14		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
15		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
16		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
17		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
18		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		
19		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		

#	Document / information	Exists? Yes / No / Not sure	Where kept	Who can access / notes
20		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure		